

Highways



"The Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamilnadu, Dr. Kalaingar Karunanidhi inaugurated the Kathivakkam Road over bridge worth Rs. 23 crores at Tiruvallur District on 30.07.2008. Ministers, MPs & all concerned Dignitaries were present during the occasion"

■ Tamil Nadu's, 'Roads' to progress

Striding the golden path of economic and social progress by massively investing in physical infrastructure like roads the State Highways Department has completed improvements and maintenance works in about 31,740 Km of roads at a cost of Rs.4,690 crores in the last 2 years. In addition, under the scheme of improving bus plying roads other Panchayat union Roads, 3,012 Km length of roads have been improved in villages at a cost of Rs. 294 crores.

Under the new scheme of improving Other District Roads (ODRs) which give connectivity to Adi-Dravidar habitations, introduced by this Government, 700 Km length of roads have been completed at a cost of Rs. 94.15 crores during the last two years including black topping of the roads (1,405 Km), leading to Adi-Dravidar habitations with NABARD assistance, at a cost of Rs.156 crores. This has benefitted 105 Adi-Dravidar habitations in Tamil Nadu. The Highways Department has also taken up maintenance works involving relaying of Panchayat and Panchayat union Roads at a cost of Rs. 250 Crores apart from renewal of roads coming under the sugarcane scheme at a cost of Rs. 35 crores.

Further in the last 2 years, 343 bridges have been built up at a total cost of Rs. 214 crores. Peranai River bridge in Dindigul district (cost Rs.5 crores). Thirumukkudal bridge in Kanyakumari district (cost Rs.7.70 crores) and Mangadu bridge in Kancheepuram district (cost Rs.2 crores) were completed in 2007-08 and open for public use.

Similarly, the bridge across Manimuthar river in Vrindhachalam town, Cuddalore district (cost Rs.5.50 crores), a bridge at Rayandapuram near Thandarampattu in Tiruvannamalai district (cost Rs.3.65 crores), Manickapangu and Madavamedu bridges in Nagapattinam district (cost Rs.1.30 crores each), Ittamozhi bridge in Tirunelveli District (cost Rs.1.30 crores), Saliyamangalam bridge in Thanjavur district (cost Rs.2.10 crores), Kumaralingam bridge in

Coimbatore district (cost Rs.1.25 crores), and Melmangalam bridge in Theni district (cost Rs.1.10 crores), have also been completed in the last 2 years.

It has been proposed to construct 4 major bridges across Cauvery river in Karur district, Kollidam in Thanjavur and Cuddalore districts and Vaigai river in Ramanathapuram district at a total cost of Rs. 121.50 crores with NABARD assistance. The preparation of Detailed Project Reports (DPR) are in progress and work will commence after finalizing tenders. In fulfillment of the long felt demand of the local public, Government has also accorded sanction for construction of fly overs along Tirunelveli Town Bye-pass near Chellapandian statue at a cost of Rs.16.40 crores. After finalisation of designs and estimates, the work will commence soon.

The Government has also launched special road projects to spur rapid mobility in Industrial and Software hubs with projects in Oragadam industrial corridor (cost Rs.300 crores), Tirupur ring roads (cost Rs. 70 crores), Coimbatore City IT Road (cost Rs.27 crores) and Madurai Radial Road Phase II (cost Rs.70 crores). Further, Rs.70 crores have been sanctioned for land acquisition to extend Rajiv Gandhi Salai from Siruseri to Mamallapuram under Phase II and the work is underway. The vision for free movement of goods and services without bottlenecks are not too distant with expending of resources of the State in this prime sector.

Launching special road projects to spur rapid mobility in industrial and software hubs the special projects like the completion of first phase of six laning of Rajiv Gandhi Salai from Taramani to Siruseri have been completed. Further sanction have been accorded for land acquisition at a cost of Rs. 70 crore and the six laning the Rajiv Gandhi Salai from Siruseri to Mamallapuram under the phase-II of the scheme are under way. The vision on free movement of goods and services with out any impediments are not too distant with expending of energies of the state in this prime sector.